

Legal Ease: Development Environment Setup

Assumed stack: React (Vite) frontend, Python FastAPI backend, PostgreSQL, Docker. You didn't specify a stack, so this is a common default. Tell me your real stack and I'll adjust it.

1. Prerequisites

Install: Git, Node.js 20 LTS, Python 3.11+, Docker Desktop, VS Code.

```
git --version
node --version      # v20.x
python3 --version   # 3.11+
docker --version
```

2. Project structure

```
legal-ease/
├── frontend/          # React + Vite
├── backend/           # FastAPI
│   ├── app/main.py
│   ├── requirements.txt
│   ├── docker-compose.yml
│   ├── .env.example
│   └── .gitignore
├── .gitignore
└── .env.example

mkdir legal-ease && cd legal-ease
git init
mkdir backend frontend
```

3. Backend (FastAPI)

```
cd backend
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate      # Windows: .venv\Scripts\activate
```

backend/requirements.txt

```
fastapi==0.115.*
uvicorn[standard]==0.30.*
sqlalchemy==2.0.*
psycopg[binary]==3.2.*
alembic==1.13.*
pydantic-settings==2.*
python-dotenv==1.*
pytest==8.*
httpx==0.27.*

pip install -r requirements.txt
```

backend/app/main.py

```
from fastapi import FastAPI

app = FastAPI(title="Legal Ease API")

@app.get("/health")
def health():
    return {"status": "ok"}

uvicorn app.main:app --reload --port 8000
```

4. Frontend (React + Vite)

```
cd ../  
npm create vite@latest frontend -- --template react-ts  
cd frontend  
npm install  
npm run dev          # http://localhost:5173
```

5. Database (Docker)

docker-compose.yml

```
services:
  db:
    image: postgres:16
    environment:
      POSTGRES_USER: ${DB_USER}
      POSTGRES_PASSWORD: ${DB_PASSWORD}
      POSTGRES_DB: ${DB_NAME}
    ports:
      - "5432:5432"
    volumes:
      - pgdata:/var/lib/postgresql/data
volumes:
  pgdata:
```

.env.example (copy to **.env**, never commit it)

```
DB_USER=legalease
DB_PASSWORD=change_me
DB_NAME=legalease
DATABASE_URL=postgresql+psycopg://legalease:change_me@localhost:5432/legalease
SECRET_KEY=change_me

cp .env.example .env
docker compose up -d db
```

6. .gitignore

```
.env
.venv/
__pycache__/
node_modules/
dist/
.DS_Store
```

7. Recommended VS Code extensions

Python, Pylance, ESLint, Prettier, Docker, GitLens.

8. Verify everything works

```
curl http://localhost:8000/health      # {"status":"ok"}
docker compose ps                      # db is running
cd backend && pytest                   # tests pass
```

9. Security note

Legal Ease likely handles confidential legal documents. Keep secrets out of Git, use separate dev and production databases, never use real client data in development, and plan for encryption at rest and access control before launch.